

Unit 1 - Introduction to Digital Marketing

Digital Marketing (DI03016011) - GTU Diploma IT Sem 3

20% weightage | 7 hours

How to use these notes: each topic is written the way you can copy it in the exam. **3 marks** = definition + 2-3 points. **4 marks** = add example or table. **7 marks** = write everything, with diagram/table and a real example. Lines marked ★ show where the topic was asked in a GTU paper (only 2 papers exist: Winter 2025 and Summer 2026).

Questions already asked from this unit (do these first)

- W2025 Q1(a) [3M: what is digital marketing + two current trends]
- BOTH papers: W2025 Q1(b) [4M: approach and customer engagement] + S2026 Q1(a) [3M: differentiate]
- W2025 Q2(a)OR [3M: P.O.E.M. framework with examples]
- S2026 Q1(c) [7M: develop an effective digital marketing strategy with example]
- S2026 Q1(c)OR [7M: voice search and conversational AI optimisation in SEO]
- S2026 Q1(b) [4M: importance of data privacy in digital marketing]

1.1 Fundamentals: definition, scope, significance

★ W2025 Q1(a) [3M: what is digital marketing + two current trends]

- **Digital marketing** is the promotion of products, services or brands using **digital channels** such as the internet, search engines, social media, email, websites and mobile apps, to reach and engage customers online.
- **Scope:** SEO, SEM / paid ads, social media marketing, email marketing, content marketing, video marketing, affiliate and influencer marketing, mobile marketing and web analytics.
- **Significance:** wide (global) reach, low cost, precise targeting, 24x7 presence, two-way communication and **measurable results** (clicks, conversions).

Two current trends (write any two)

- **AI-powered marketing** - chatbots, personalised recommendations and automated campaigns (e.g. Amazon 'recommended for you').
- **Short-form video** - Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok-style videos get very high engagement.
- Voice search and conversational AI (Alexa, Siri); Metaverse / AR-VR experiences; zero-click searches.

1.1 Traditional vs Digital Marketing

★ BOTH papers: W2025 Q1(b) [4M: approach and customer engagement] + S2026 Q1(a) [3M: differentiate]

Point	Traditional marketing	Digital marketing
Medium	TV, radio, newspaper, hoardings, pamphlets	Internet: websites, search, social media, email, apps
Approach	One-way broadcast - same message to everybody	Targeted and personalised message to a chosen audience
Customer engagement	Little or no direct response; feedback is slow	Two-way: likes, comments, shares, chats, instant reply
Cost	High (ad space, printing, airtime)	Lower; start with a small budget
Reach	Local / limited by geography	Global, 24x7
Measurement	Difficult and slow (guess-work)	Real-time and exact (clicks, conversions, ROI)
Flexibility	Cannot change once printed or aired	Can edit or pause a campaign any time
Example	Newspaper ad of a shop	Instagram ad targeted to people near the shop

Exam tip: For 3 marks write the first five rows. For the 4-mark 'approach and engagement' question, explain the two bold rows in 2 lines each, then add cost and measurement.

1.2 Evolution and growth of digital marketing

Year (approx.)	Milestone
1990s	First search engines and email; first clickable banner ad (1994); Google founded 1998
2000s	Social media begins: Facebook (2004), YouTube (2005), Twitter (2006); blogs and online ads grow
2007-2012	Smartphones (iPhone 2007) - mobile marketing, apps, Instagram (2010)
2015-2020	Video and influencer marketing, marketing automation, short video (TikTok)
2022 onwards	Generative AI, chatbots, personalisation at scale, Reels / Shorts, voice search

- **Mobile technology:** most people browse on phones, so mobile-friendly sites, apps, SMS and location-based ads matter.
- **AI:** predicts customer behaviour, writes content, powers chatbots and personal recommendations.
- **Automation:** tools send emails, schedule posts and run ad rules automatically, saving time (e.g. Mailchimp, HubSpot).

1.3 Digital marketing strategy: P.O.E.M. framework

★ W2025 Q2(a)OR [3M: P.O.E.M. framework with examples]

P.O.E.M. = Paid, Owned, Earned Media - the three types of media a brand uses in its digital marketing strategy.

PAID media
(you pay)

OWNED media
(you control)

EARNED media
(others give you)

Media	Meaning	Examples
Paid	Space or reach you pay for	Google Ads, Instagram / Facebook ads, sponsored posts, influencer promotion
Owned	Channels the brand owns and controls	Website, blog, mobile app, email list, YouTube channel, social media pages
Earned	Publicity gained for free through audience / media	Customer reviews, shares and mentions, word of mouth, news coverage, user-generated content

Example - Nike: paid = YouTube ads; owned = nike.com and Nike app; earned = fans sharing photos with its shoes and media talking about a campaign.

1.4 Planning and execution of a digital marketing strategy

★ S2026 Q1(c) [7M: develop an effective digital marketing strategy with example]

A **digital marketing strategy** is a plan that decides **what to achieve, for whom, through which channels, and how to measure it**. Steps:

1. **Market research and target audience:** find who the customers are (age, location, interests, needs), study competitors. Make buyer personas.
2. **Set objectives (SMART):** Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. E.g. 'get 500 website visitors and 50 orders in 3 months'.
3. **Set the budget.**
4. **Select digital channels** (use the P.O.E.M. mix): website + SEO, social media, email, paid ads (Google / Meta).
5. **Plan content and a calendar:** blogs, posts, videos, offers, and when to publish.
6. **Execute** the campaigns using tools (Canva, Mailchimp, Meta Ads Manager).
7. **Measure and optimise:** track KPIs (traffic, CTR, conversion rate, ROI) with Google Analytics and improve.

Example: a local bakery 'Sweet Delights'

Step	Action
Audience	Families and young adults within 10 km who order birthday cakes
Objective	100 online cake orders in 3 months
Channels	Website with SEO (Owned), Instagram Reels and Google Local ads (Paid), customer reviews and shares (Earned), WhatsApp / email offers
Content	Reels of cake making, 'cake of the week', festival offers
Measure	Website visits, orders, Instagram reach, cost per order

1.5 Latest trends in digital marketing

★ S2026 Q1(c)OR [7M: voice search and conversational AI optimisation in SEO]

Trend	What it means	Example
AI-powered marketing	AI chatbots answer customers; AI recommends products and writes / personalises content	Amazon / Netflix recommendations, website chatbots
Voice search and conversational AI	People search by speaking; assistants answer in natural language	'Alexa, find a cake shop near me'
Short-form video	Videos of 15-60 seconds give high reach and engagement	Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok-style videos
Metaverse, AR/VR	Immersive brand experiences, virtual try-on / virtual stores	IKEA place - view furniture in your room with AR
Zero-click searches and featured snippets	Answer shown on the results page itself, user need not click	Weather, 'what is SEO' answer box

- **Voice search:** users speak to assistants (Alexa, Siri, Google Assistant) instead of typing.
- **Conversational AI:** AI systems (chatbots, AI assistants) that understand natural language and reply like a human.

How voice queries are different

- Longer and **natural / question-type** ('where is the nearest shoe repair shop open now?') versus typed 'shoe repair'.
- Often **local** ('near me') and on mobile.

- The assistant reads **one answer** aloud - usually from the featured snippet.

How to optimise (role in SEO)

1. Use **long-tail, conversational keywords** and question words (what, how, where, best).
2. Create **FAQ pages** and give short, direct answers (2-3 lines) to target **featured snippets / position zero**.
3. Apply **schema (structured data)** so the machine understands the content.
4. Strong **local SEO**: complete Google Business Profile with address, timings, phone.
5. Make the site **fast and mobile-friendly** and use HTTPS.
6. Write in a natural, easy-to-read tone, with clear headings.

Example: A pizza shop adds an FAQ 'What time does Pizza Point open?' with the short answer and its Business Profile. When someone asks Siri 'pizza places open now', the shop is more likely to be read out.

Conclusion: voice search and AI assistants reward clear, direct, local and well-structured content.

1.6 Ethical considerations and data privacy

★ S2026 Q1(b) [4M: importance of data privacy in digital marketing]

Digital marketers collect lots of **personal data** (name, phone, email, location, browsing and purchase history). **Data privacy** means collecting, storing and using this data lawfully, with the user's consent, and keeping it safe.

Why it is important

1. **Builds trust** and loyal customers - people share data only with brands they trust.
2. **Legal compliance** - laws like GDPR, CCPA and India's DPDP Act give heavy fines for misuse.
3. **Protects the brand** from data breaches and bad publicity.
4. **Ethical marketing** - respects people's choice (opt-in, opt-out, no spam).
5. Shapes campaigns: **first-party data**, consent-based marketing and cookie-less tracking.

Law	Region	Key idea
GDPR	European Union (2018)	Clear consent, right to access / delete data, heavy fines
CCPA	California, USA	Users can know, delete and opt out of the sale of their data
DPDP Act, 2023	India	Consent-based processing of digital personal data; duties for data fiduciaries; rights for data principals

Impact on campaigns: (1) collect **first-party data** directly (forms, sign-ups, loyalty); (2) move from third-party cookies to **cookie-less tracking**; (3) use **consent banners** and double opt-in emails.

Last-minute revision sheet - Unit 1

- Digital marketing = promotion through digital channels; measurable, targeted, low cost, two-way.
- Traditional vs digital: one-way vs two-way, costly vs cheaper, hard vs easy to measure.
- P.O.E.M. = Paid, Owned, Earned media.
- Plan: research audience → SMART objectives → budget → channels → content → execute → measure.
- Trends: AI, voice search, short video, metaverse/AR-VR, zero-click.
- Laws: GDPR (EU), CCPA (USA), DPDP Act 2023 (India). First-party data, cookie-less tracking, consent.